

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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EXPERIENCE

StaffRoom AI

Founder & AI Solutions Consultant

Emeryville, CA

October 2023 - Present

- Adult workplace discovery: watch how a team actually works, listen without rushing, and write instructions the next adult can follow so the work continues without me in the room.
- Trained an operations team to run and extend a workflow I had built, then let them own it. Processing time fell 98% against a measured baseline, and I stayed available after they took over.
- Designed a content system with the people who would run it, and stayed until they could operate it without me.
- Delivered EZ-AI, problem-first training for adult domain experts, starting from the learner's real work and treating their judgment as the thing to keep. Adult learners only.
- After a handoff I stay available, write down what is still not working, and change the work when the people who own it tell me to. Comfortable receiving guidance and revising.

Wiz Music

Community Development Intern

Barcelona, Spain

May 2022 - July 2022

- Observed a multilingual adult community (English, Spanish, Catalan) from its own analytics, segmented churn by tenure and joins by source, and raised the finding when reported growth was not organic.

Valhalla Healthcare

Machine Learning Engineer (Intern)

Remote

May 2021 - August 2021

- Built a human-in-the-loop model over handwritten clinical notes (F1 80.03) for one adult customer, not children.

IBM

Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer, Customer Support

Austin, TX

August 2018 - December 2020

- Led discovery sessions with colleagues, listened for what they actually needed, and wrote the release notes and documentation that walked them through each change.
- Built a Slack tool that surfaced similar past cases for support engineers, then stayed through check-ins until common issues resolved in a single response.
- Designed IBMLogAnalyze, a data pipeline and dashboard that removed 1 to 3 hours of log-analysis prep per case, then documented it so engineers could run it themselves.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder

B.S. Information Science; Major GPA 3.7 | Certificate of Cognitive Science; Dean's List

Boulder, CO

August 2018 - May 2023

- Cognitive psychology, including graduate seminar PSYC 7215; Advanced Cognitive Psychology (PSYC 4145); User-Centered Design; Community-Based Design.

RC Health Services

Emergency Medical Technician

Austin, TX

2024

- Adult emergency assessment, BLS, and team communication under uncertainty. Not pediatric CPR or First Aid.

Bondi Outdoor Leadership

AIARE 1 Avalanche Safety and Rescue

Colorado

March 2022

SKILLS

Presence & enablement: observation of adult work, active listening, process mapping, 1:1 adult training, receiving guidance and revising, writing instructions others can follow.

Learning sciences: Certificate of Cognitive Science; cognitive psychology; user-centered design. No AMI/AMS credential, no ECE units, no classroom or 0 to 3 tenure.

Languages & licensing: English (native), Spanish (conversational). EMT (2024), not pediatric CPR. Willing to obtain pediatric CPR, First Aid, ECE units, TB, MMR, Tdap, and Live Scan.

Outdoors: AIARE 1 avalanche rescue. Live and work aboard a 1966 sailboat on the SF Bay.